

INTERVIEWS at Villages with different people:

2002

YH: Bingül Yavuz; Emine Doğan; Ahmet & Esmâ; CRAFTS

A. Ömerler; Herding; Cow Milking

BK: Uprising for Land ownership

YK: Village; Land disputes vis a vis Treasury; Ağıls; Milk industry project

A. ÖMERLER, Fevzi Akyar; AĞILS

HH DEFINITIONS

ÖMER UTGU, Milk Production

Kızıllı Çiftliği- Once there were vineyards there;

Herding and Milking; ÇK Ağıls – Ahmet Başol

BASRI has 1,000 sheep and goats

2002 transcr.Ahmet Başol –

16.6.'02

Going with Naomi and Mac to collect plants from several fold areas, to see if the currently used agıl vegetation is different from that of abandoned ones. We went to Magara Ağıl and Orta Ağıl at ÇK. Reason village is called ÇK is because there used to be vineyards at Kızıllı Çiftlik (ie. perhaps they grew grapes without pits..)

Kızıllı Çiftlik/yayla is 52,000 d. Its boundaries: Medetkaşı, Öküzyatağı (batı), Çifttehöyükler, Sülüklü kaşı, Kabayazı seti, Akhöyük, Sırakayalar, Keklikpınarı, Çimenin üstü. It starts c. 5 km from center of ÇK. **This was all grazing by Abbaslar, Beypazarı herders and Kışlak'lar.**

At YH village originally there were 3 families: M. Ali Ağa, Hacı Mehmet, Deli Mehmet.. Their shepherds brought the herds to Kızıllı and Ezineli Çiftliği also.



We are at ÇK, Mağara Ağıl, AZ-1, Kızıllı Mevkii.

Usage: Bolu Shepherds: from Nov.-May;

July-Nov.: ÇK herds go there, graze on anız, sleep outside, near AZ-1.

AZ Ağıl - For **she-goats originally**, but now for sheep. Could accommodate 2000 animals. There is a wooden gate to separate the front from the interior of the cave. It is called “almazlık”, if the ewe does not nurse her lamb or goat/kid, they are put there to get “to know” each other.

This is a very deep cave, it has an opening at the other end, some lambs got lost walking through it. There is a lot of droppings in front, left from last winter.

Bolu shepherds come with 1,000 sheep. They are “katıntı”..

The owners come periodically, to buy provisions for the shepherd, then leave. In March, when lambs are born, owners are here, to help and count. The lambs stay on for another 2 months, then owner takes them to Bolu or for sale.

Transport: the shepherds and herd used to walk, from Bolu to Kızıllı, about 1 week, through fields.

“Yayıla yayıla yürür”; at night the shepherd ties a sheep to his leg, so he is alerted to wake up in case of danger.

There is a lot of grazing land around, interspersed with small patches of farmland.

ORTA AĞIL - used to belong to **Abbas** family. They were the owners of Kızıllı Çiftlik.

It has not been used for at least 40 years. The only remains is a small piece of stone wall.

(Naomi took a picture for me). No members of the family exists.

Abbas had at least 3 folds..Erkeç, Orta Ağıl, Mağara. 3,000-4,000 sheep and goats.

Vineyards near Orta Ağıl. ..near it there is elm (karaağaç) and and poplar, near stream.

HOUSEHOLD- Ahmet Başal- Born in 1925. Esmâ and Ahmet married and lived with mo-in-law and her mother in ÇK. No fa-in-law, he was dead. So there were 3 women, 1 man and one boy (Esmâ's son). Esmâ is from KH.

LABOR: Ahmet askerdeydi; Harmanda “bekar” tutardık; bekar yine tarlayı sürerdi. Koyunları çobana katıntı yapardık; ben ineklere bakardım.Ahmedin annesi ebeydi, köyü dolaşırdı.

She died young, of measles. We lived in the same courtyard, but built our own house.

After Ahmet got back from Military, two of us worked. **We sold wheat to the Office in Polatlı by horse carriage, it took a day to go back and forth.** We used to produce 4 çuval of wheat (200 kg.)

(in early 40's with dry-farming, 1d. yielded 15 yarım (15x16)=240 kg.) So, Ahmet did not have much land. Perhaps 5-10 d. But they had sheep.

CRAFTS: We **wove “hasır”** from papir (kamuş). I did it for the flooring. When Sakarya flooded there were a lot of reeds.. so dede collected it, and I wove it.

Esmâ: “this dede is naughty—one day we were weaving it together. He told me to stop at some point. I did not, so he took the knife and cut up the whole thing. Why did you do it? “Well she did not listen to me when I asked her to stop”. Did you get angry? Of course, but what good does it do?

But we lived together for 62 years: “ o beni taşıdı, ben onu, öylece idare ettik.”

Now I am sick, dede takes care of me; da-in-law makes the food, and we eat it.

PRESENT HOUSEHOLD: Esmâ and Ahmet; their son and da-in-law; they have 5 children, 1 lives there, daughter lives in Polatlı, rest live in Eskişehir. Esmâ, Ahmet and their son's family, all live together. The son and his wife do all the work around the house and the fields. Do the others contribute to work?

No, they have their own work. They only come for bayram, düğün/dernek etc..

What about the inheritance? It is equal. When dede and Esmâ die, they'll all ask for their share.

Head of Household: It is Ahmet Başal. Bizde ölmeden evvel birşey "üleştirilmez "

When the kids got married we gave them money, jobs, homes in Eskişehir..but only one son works on the land, the eldest one.

LAND: Dede has 80 d. of land, and 5 kids. Four don't live in the village. What they inherit they will probably sell; probably the eldest son will buy it and continue the farming tradition. Did he??

Laborers: They were not part of the HH. They got paid, until the job was finished.

Milking at Evening in ÇK: at village ağıl. Speaking with Recep Şahin.

His ağıl is KT at 950m.

Accommodates c. 500 sheep. Now he and his br-in-law have 300.

Women are separating their own herds, tie them together, and milk them.

Herding Cycle: May-Nov , they are grazing, don't go into folds, "nerde akşam, orda sabah".

When it starts to rain, they are in kır ağıl, they still graze on and off, until snow.

Jan-March, herds are in village fold. We try to keep them as much as possible on landscape.

NO. of HERDS in ÇK: up until 80's, it was 10,000. Now, only 2,500. No goats.It's not so profitable.

Yes, the goat is kibar and nazik. Tries to eat as much from the land, doesn't eat so much feed as sheep. But he catches cold, and aborts.

Too bad, his milk yields more than sheep's milk. But his wool and kid have no market.

Milking: In 1 hour we milked 24 sheep.

HOUSEHOLDS – YH

22.6.02

I compiled a list of YH households, of present date. (76 HH; pop: c.350).

It was interesting that most of the people I asked about the number of members in each HH and how many accounts were in each HH, most informants were correct about the others. This tells me that there is good information flow within the village.

Kazım Tekin's wife **Aynur** was especially very knowledgeable. Births, deaths, illness, houses bought/sold,

divorced daughters coming back to father's house etc...

Important to note: What is a household? At YH, I find several variations:

- (a) economic unity (members of HH working together, eating together and sharing the income)+ co-residence in same courtyard, in same or different houses;
- (b) economic unity+living in another house, not in courtyard (that could be in YH or Polatlı)
- (c) **some** economic sharing+living in courtyard and/ or outside;
- (d) no economic sharing; sharing important activities together (wedding, festival, mevlit etc) +living outside the courtyard or outside YH
- (e) head person of the HH (real or titular) Oldest Male

- Economic unity means, sharing field labor, machinery, income and expenditure; housework, repairing house. Taking care of children, taking care of sick relatives are part of the obligation of family members (especially parents).
- Generally, the courtyard is the place where several houses accommodate members of a HH. If they don't live in the same courtyard, they live in a house very close-by, making labor sharing and other activities convenient.
- In the last 10-15 years, most of the families in YH and villages nearby, have bought or rented homes in Polatlı to send their kids to school, and the grandparents move with their grandchildren there in winter. So the families split up, keep two homes, at two nearby places. **Towns grow, villages shrink, on seasonal basis**, at first, then the village will probably merge up with Polatlı. In summer families meet at the village again to share labor and life together.

Transcription:

Aşağı Ömerler

22.6.2002-

Yukarı Ömerler is c. 32 km. from YH; 17 km from Aşağı Ömerler.

At the home of **Fevzi Akyar**. Household consists of wife, two gelin, 2 sons, 6 grandchildren- altogether 11 people--they all live together, and work together except for the wife who goes to Polatlı with grandchildren in winter and stays there. Fevzi commutes back and forth between Polatlı and Ömerler.

1) Why did the village move down? **Need for Water (irrigation) and Population increase.**

2) Why did the village wait so long to move? There was a lot of mosquitoes, land had reeds, and it belonged to the State. It was designated as MERA. It took a while to clean it up. The Muhtar worked very hard to get it to be designated as Treasury Land, which the HH then could buy...**each was allocated 700 d. for house and garden**, they got their deeds and **will pay over a period of 20 years**. For building houses they borrowed money from the Köy İşleri...though two contractors screwed them, they still built.

Unfortunately the houses are concrete cubes; but there is a 3-storey mosque, cut stone and very well-built, it has a shiny tin/steel dome.

There were 150 HH at Yukarı Ömerler. Population of c. 700. So far only half of the village came down. We spent our life traveling between the two, since our most prolific fields are near Porsuk. Daily travel of c. 40 km. Expensive and tiring. As population grew, we needed more agricultural products; we also do some herding near the new village now, we grow clover for additional feed.

Another problem was drinking water. We do have drinking water at the Y. Ömerler from a spring. But it was not enough for the whole population. **Now we brought drinking water from Çimenceğiz to A. Ömerler for drinking water.** We have a depot for 200 tons built here. We will get pipes laid down both for sewage and drinking water to reach each home.

Before, women used to come from the village to the fields near Porsuk, to weed, water, harrow sugar beet, onion etc..on tractors...Went back home at 8:00 pm. Then, we'd milk sheep and cows.

It was tough on women too.

Herding: Now we don't milk the sheep. It is for wool and meat only. Because the women in the family are not well, one has asthma, another has muscular rheumatism (eklem romatizması), wife is elderly. I still have 2 shepherds to herd them. When we lived upland, I did the herding myself.

In the past herding was very important here. From Kıriscık we had c. 40 shepherds, each with 100 or so animals. They also added our animals to theirs (katıntı), they stayed in our folds, we paid them some wages. In summer they left. This continued till 1990's; after that it decreased.

What replaced it are the "green" crops—onion, sugar beet, melon..

Do you miss your old house? [question to women] Yes, it was better there, there are lots of mosquitoes here. We had neighbors there. It is comfortable here, though. We can grow vegetables here; there was no water over there.

Origins: We are from Horasan, Erzurum. Yörük groups came from there, settled here, Sarioba, Türkoba..I am from a Yörük family.

My grandparents were herders, so, it is in my blood..I go visit with my shepherd, take him food and stay near the folds sometimes. My father had 1,000 sheep, 1,000 goats..Now I have only 200.

When those dogs see me, they greet me by jumping all over me. Our old shepherds came from Kıriscık. Those knew their craft; now they are a bit dim-witted.

What replaced it is the "green" cash crops—onion, sugar beet, melon..

Now sugar beet is restricted; the government has a "kota" per HH.. we don't get paid if we produce more. 1 d. yields 5-8 tons of sugar beet. For ex. I can only grow 30 d. If we had a factory nearby, we would have been able to grow more.

ÖM-5 – Originally belonged to Fevzi..now his cousin uses it...completely surrounded by fields now..planted and Nadas. (I took a picture to show the difference since last year).

AGRICULTURE – Wheat and barley are the main crops; they are both irrigated near Porsuk floodplain, and also under dry farming upland, near the Y. Ömerler.

He has 250 d. land; 60 d. sugar beet and onion, rest is cereals. Only the dry farm is left to fallow. 150 d. is cereals; 40 d. is fallow.

Even at Porsuk, fields which are 3-5 km. Distance, we cannot irrigate.

In the past there was intermittent poverty; we ate barley and corn bread. It was dark and hard.

Y. Ömerler is at c. 1,000 m. Water from Çimenceğiz did not get up there.

COW MILKING –

Yes, we have increase of milk cows here too. Holsteins-- we feed them “yonca”.. So, we grow yonca.

Pregnant Cows are not milked 4 months before birth.. after calf is born, she nurses from 2 “tits” and we milk the other two. So, we can get milk c. 8 months of the year.

How profitable is it? Depends on the cost of feed and the price of milk, and the market.

In the past we had native cows, they only gave 5 kg/day. Now buyers come from Ayaş, but they only pay 200,000 TL/kg..of milk; they sell it for 500,000 in Polatlı. But at YH the governor has arranged for a better buying price, so they come 2x/day, pay right away, this milk goes to Temelli where there is a central storage before being shipped to Ankara. Presumably goes to Danon factory.

But from Ömerler it does not go to Danon.

Does milk industry affect sheep herding? No, they are two different types of meat. People need them both.

15.6.02

Emine Doğan, YH. (write notes from notebook)

48 yrs. old.

Her husband was Niyazi Doğan's son, Rıza. She is a widow for 18 yrs. He died in a tractor accident. She Never married again. They were from the same village in Beypazarı. They went to YH after 16 years. She had her children in Beypazarı. Niyazi came to YH before. Emine's husband did both farming and herding.

She continued doing the same, after he died. She has 110 sheep; she and her fa-in-law share a shepherd for herding them. They have also about 120.

Zeyni, İlhami, Hidayet Karagöz, Emine- (5) they all share 1 shepherd, c. 400 sheep. They graze at KK, Sülüklü during the day. Each family does cleaning the fold, shearing. Emine is tired.

Household- consists of 4 adults, 2 children. My sons help me with the fields. I have 150 d. half wheat, half barley. Veg. Garden in the courtyard.

PRODUCTION: She milks 70 sheep, makes 250 kg. of cheese/year.

Of the new lambs, 1/3 is added to the existing herd. I have both Karaman and Merinos. Karaman is good for bedding and meat. Karaman is easier to take care of. It is more sturdy, eats less.

We are all one HH: Niyazi Doğan + Zekiye; they have children (Zeyni, İsa; wives, Fatma(3 children), Nurgül (3 children). Emine lives in another courtyard, but very close to the others. **Emine equates HH with family.** But they are economically separate, though they have labor cooperation and supportive of each other when they are in need. “Hastalıkta destek çıkarız; işini yetiştiremezse, yardım ederiz; parasal yardım. We all eat separately.

Tarlada yardım var..

Daily Work Cycle: I get up at 5 am.

Abdest/Namaz; milking cows, then sheep (sons, shepherd, Müzeyyen, da-in-law, Emine); then, breakfast; make cheese, yoghurt; butter. Housework (cooking, cleaning, taking care of children); gardening. Shepherd leaves around 8 am.

The younger son goes to the field and works with workers.

Meltem, Emine's da-in-law, learned to milk sheep by observation. I thought you milked cow in the same way as sheep. Apparently you sit on its side, not in the back.

Müzeyyen Simsek and Niyazi Doğan are cousins (amca çocukları); Emine was married to Niyazi's son; so, Müzeyyen Simsek and Emine are related by marriage.

Now that M. husband Ömer is dead, Emine helps her out with adding M.'s few sheep to Doğan family herd, and helps M. with milking. M. gives her certain amount of the milk. Their houses are next door to each other.

Müzeyyen sold all her sheep after Ömer died. She should have thought more before selling. Emine knew all about milk processing before marriage. She enlarged her herd since her husband died. And she continues to do so. If her fa-in-law and daughter did not encourage her, she also would have sold the herd like Müzeyyen.

Müzeyyen has 3 brothers in the village: Ibrahim, Hayrettin (dead, widow lives there) , Orhan.

They all live together in one courtyard, but separate houses. Their wives also.

Hayrettin's son married Emine's daughter, and they live in Polatlı.

Both Hayrettin and wife Fatma are deaf mutes but all their kids were normal and intelligent. One of the sons married to Emine's daughter.

MELTEM – (Emine's da-in-law)Kaymaktan yağ yapıyor. Eskiden hiç birşey bilmiyordum diyor.

After marriage she learned the ways of the village. Her own mother is also from Müslim village.

She learned that when she first came on her wedding day that she should not get out of the car until her

She learned that when she first came on her wedding day that she should not get out of the car until her mo*in*law gave her a cow. Also, when relatives gave her money at the wedding she should not open her hand until they gave her gold. So, she adapted pretty quickly.

15. 6. 2002

Beyliköprü Land Disputes, 1975 (İsyan).

At Kayran House, with Ünver Kayran, Önder and their relatives from BK, Hüseyin Şener.

Pembe Kayran, mother of Önder and Ünver, is from BK.

In 1950, there was land reform; Menderes regime gave each HH 200 d. land. But those deeds were not accepted by the next Ecevit government ('70s). Only the older, pre-Menderes deeds were accepted, and those were only 40 d. each, belonging to Ağa. So, much of the land was again reappropriated by the government.

Since 1950 we have had land disputes at BK among 3 groups: the Treasury, Villagers and Muhtar. At that time there were 5 HH in the village (BK). These were the Ağa families. One of those was Pembe's family.

Villagers claimed the land, Hazine claimed it and Muhtar was on the Hazine side. The dispute went on for 25 years. Along with laborers and migrant workers joining the HHs, they started a rebellion.

Started a conflict with the Ağa families. The villagers started tilling land which the Ağa families had claims on. So, the Ağa families had their workers request land from the Treasury. So the families grew to c. 25, living off the land. (Had the workers gotten the land and become the residents there, there would not be any revolting; the 5 ağa families would still be prevailing). In the meantime, the cases of the Ağa families were unfairly settled by political maneuvering...While the Ağa families had deeds, the boundaries of their lands were unknown as they were defined only by features like ağıl or streams, or old place-names. Because the boundaries were vague, the existing '70s government (Ecevit) decided that they would reduce the 20,000 d. claimed land by the Ağa families to 600 d. and distribute the rest to other claims, each claiming party getting 40-50 d. Yani burada hukukun katledilmesi olayı var, said Ünver. (The Ağa families as a last resort brought in Yörük people from Konya for support, to shield themselves against the local people and the government. But the yörüks turned against them in the final analysis too).

This revolt can be seen as part of a larger **Socialist** movement in the 70s in Turkey. Ecevit's Motto was: (toprak işleyenin, su kullananın). This resulted in revolts in other Polatlı villages as well. **Its main aim was to get votes for the Halk Partisi.**

In 1975 they started to till the lands before the court cases were settled. This started the revolt

In 1975 they started to till the lands before the court cases were settled.. This started the revolt.

They beat up the ağa families. The latter left. This was part of the larger political scheme.

Now it is one of the 3 largest villages in Polatlı, pop. 400 HH. ŞÖ, BK, Uzunbeyli near Konya.

It has also become a central weighing station for wheat to be sold to TMO. There is also a train station there.

YENİ KÖSELER- İSMAİL GÜLEN (75 yrs. Old)

2.7.01

YK is 220 HH today; it was 80 HH in 1956.

One of His sons is a judge in Ankara.

He is from Kibriscık; his ancestors are originally from Crimea. Most of the later settlers were from Bolu region, as the rest of the inhabitants of the region. **The original settlers are from Horasan (Türkmenistan).**

"I was not a herder myself; I came in 1956. The meras make boundaries for each village.

Routes followed from Kibriscık: Beypazarı, Sarıoba, **(Kibriscık-YK – 140 km)**; (Kibriscık-Beypazarı: 51 km) . By walking it would take 2-3 weeks with herds.

My parents did herding; little agriculture. Now in Bolu only the elderly shepherds are doing herding; the young people are educated, they go to cities, become teachers etc...

Past: **Yield of 1 dönüm land= 1 koyun in terms of what it can buy or barter;**

1 d. yields 16 kg. of flour; (160 kg from 1 d.yields 16 kg flour).

A family of 5 needs 125 sheep or 125 d. of land; or 25 sheep, plus 50 d. land for subsistence.

Gençali, Ömerler, YK and Karacaahmet – their grazing land was one large land, before they became separated: area of 11x15 km= 165 km² = 16,500 hectares

If we consider 5 animals in a hectare, then in the past, this area would have the potential of providing grazing land for 82,500 animals. (In the Sakarya eastern zone, the figure was 30,000 ha. and 150,000 animals could be potentially grazed).

22.6.2002

YENİ KÖSELER (cont.)

At YK. At the mosque courtyard, later at the teahouse. A man of 94 years old is sitting in the courtyard for afternoon prayers. Other men are also waiting for the prayers.

Names: Köy Bekcisi, Coşkun Yılmaz, Ömer Karaali.

HH: 300: Pop: over 1 000 (Earlier figure for HH given by Ismail dede did not account for individual families in

111,000, 1 sp. over 1,000. (Earlier figure for 111 given by Ismail dede did not account for individual families in each HH. This figure given by younger men is more because it separates each family as an economic unit, therefore a separate HH).

Total Land: 90,000 d.

Agriculture: 60,000 d. (30-35 d. unirrigated—it can be a loss); healthy agr.

Irrigated: 25,000, on the plain.

Unirrigated ; 35,000d. will yield 150-160 kg/d.. That represent loss.

Unusable: 12,000 taşlık

What saves us is the “green crops”.

Grazing: c. 3,000 d. at Belkavak and Yayla. Mera is little. Sheep – goat about 1,500.

From 1974-83, we used the best fertilizer, we got very good yield. Herding was also very good.

Until 1995, we had about 15,000 sheep-goats. Also, fuel and fertilizer together were balanced with wheat price. Now it is much lower.

I kg of wheat equalled in price to 1 lt. Of fuel. Now fuel price is 5x 1 kg of wheat. Also, soil got depleted.... Nadas was not applied rigorously...one-year nadas was very profitable. Nadas, ikilemek, kazayağı (2)....now we only do nadas, and not the rest. Because we cant afford the diesel. We also irrigate some of the wheat fields. We irrigate them with canals...from Sakarya,

From about 13-14 km., from an area called Dölleme there are canals. That is for upland irrigation.

Near Sakarya it is also irrigated. Near the ağıls land is kıraç, that is where the canal irrigation is.

SETTLEMENT SHIFT – (like at Ömerler).

We used to have two villages, summer (Yayla) and winter: our grandparents told us about it.

Summer was at Belkavak—we still have remains of our villages there, with cemetery etc.

They took the herds there and stayed for 3 months. Came down here in winter.

Kızıldikmen was also very good mera (we found 5 ağıls there). Water plentiful, lots of grass.

Now they are building Kargı Baraj, at Çağlayık, below Dümrek, near Saray. (2 yrs. ago they told me about the dam, at Dümrek). Using Sakarya. Dümrek and Köçek villages will be gone. Dümrek people will be settled in Konya. Also, a few of us will lose 50-60 d. of land where the land will be flooded.

LAND DISTRIBUTION-

Mera is State Land; the rest is Treasury. When Land is distributed, it is from the Treasury Land. The latter is also part of the state. But they have separate accounts.

Our land is rented from the Treasury at present; soon, the Land Reform Act will be applied to YK. At present the rents still go to the State coffers. At YH the Treasury sold the land to the people. We are

present the rents still go to the State control. At 111, the Treasury sold the land to the people. We are not there yet. The Cadastral Office has to measure our land, and then make the distribution. In this case it is difficult because the land is very rough/broken up.

In the village we set aside 13,000 d. land and called it "Taşlık"; in reality it is suitable for agriculture. We presented it to the Treasury for sale to people through the Reform Act (Interesting, some of the villagers disputed the parceling of 13,000 d. land for agriculture, arguing that it should have been used as mera, to add to the greening of the environment..others clearly argued for more productivity).. There was only 700 d. Treasury land for 113 persons with no land. This would have been totally inadequate. So, we are now waiting for the Cadastral Service to measure it and send it to the Treasury. It is delayed because of lack of Cadastral Funds. We are still waiting for about 10 yrs.

Kadastro Hazine ile anlaşamıyor, çünkü para vermeyince Kadastro da ölçüm yapmıyor, sonuç:

Köylü hala beklemekte.... They are always commenting about State not helping.

At YK, about 2/3 of people have deeds for land, 1/3 has no land: We got land in 1954, then again in 1968. İşlenmiş toprak köylünün bir çeşit fabrikası. Onun buğdayı sade ona değil, daha kaç kişiye ekmek sağlıyor.

Milk Industry: They have a Project in mind: there is a very productive mera land near Sakarya, it is called Dölleme Mevkii. They could develop that into a cow pasture, to breed local milk cows, and to eventually establish a milk industry...but to do that they need a loan from the State. They applied to the Kaymakam, told him that it was the most fertile area for pasture; it would feed the fourth generation in this village.. He said they had the right to use it as mera, but they had to follow it up through the Treasury themselves.

Right now the area is overgrazed; but we can convert that into cow grazing by growing clover and çayır, because there is water coming from springs. WE NEED TO DEVELOP SOME NEW AREAS OF PRODUCTIVITY- because agriculture is becoming unprofitable - MILK INDUSTRY IS A POSSIBILITY – but we need financial assistance.

YENİ KÖSELER -

[From 1999 notes] See notes: Landuse W. Sakarya, 1999

Local Name:

Fold code: YK-1

Belkavak Mvk. (Hüseyinler Bayırı)

Hacı Halil ağılı (dedesinden kalma)

Has 3 more ağıls.

Location to village:

Y. Köşeler

Type of fold:

closed..can house 2000

Photo: Cam #2

Roll 2: 16-24

Topog. features of location:**Description and notes:**

The owner's descendants are not here; so the village rents the ağıl..Shepherd comes from Beypazarı; stays here 8 months, because we have a lot of grass here.

Drinks water below Belkavak, there is a fountain there..

There are two kids in the open fold, and a billy goat under the roof..may be they are sick..the shepherd is out with the herd; he left some oak leaves and water for the goats..but the kids got out and started roaming around, looking for real food, munching around the fold.

There is a water tank near the shepherd's hut.

Behind this ağıl, c. 500 m. away there is another one- -belonged to Ömer' Ünal..he had about 700 sheep and goats.. he had several ağıls dispersed according to seasonal vegetation..Summer, fall, spring...**This indicates abundance of both grazing and sheep/goat pop.**

Part of Kıranharman was grazing land for Y. Köseleler...Y. Köseleler grazing land was very big up until 1930's..

30.6.02

Yeni Köseleler – with Ismail Gülen, Naomi, Nedim and Mac. Collecting Trip to ağıls. About 8 km north and northwest. From the village.

Yayla Döллеme Ağılı (as described by İsmail)– at c. 790 m. It is a big one, accommodates c. 1,000. Only used occasionally. In the past it was used as Yaz Ağılı (kuzu doğduktan sonra kullanılıyor), after the ewes give birth, closer to Sakarya. (Check out the big color topo map for locations and also two maps for West Sakarya that Jason drew). Till Nov. they go to highland (Çiftarkaçlar- high slope). After, they go 2 km. west of it, at 950 m. for the winter. It is called **Kış Ağılı**, which was used, but no longer used. Why separate them into seasons?

- More convenient for new birthing ewes in Spring to be on lower ground,
- near the water (c. 1 km).
- They don't get tired by walking on upland broken-up terrain.

There used to be in this region several pairs of ağıls, one for Summer and one for Winter. We did not bring them to the village. Döллеme mvk ağıls are always near the water, and flatland, and where summer folds are located. There are big stones for salt around the fold.

Shepherd's hut is built of stone. It was locked; outside is a bowl of "Top", barley bread for his dogs. Also tea pots, a coal stove for cooking etc.

This was built about 40 years ago, still in use.

Kış ağıl is older, it is not functioning; belongs to the same man who owns Yaz ağıl.

Vegetation: next to ağıl it is very badly overgrazed and now tilled; c. 200 m. there is much more vegetation, because it is grazed but not tilled; there is yavsan, kekik, üzerlik otu ve bahar bitkileri..

11.6.02

Ömer Utgu (M.Ali'nin oğlu, Zeki's brother)

MILK PRODUCTION – Household #: 8 (two nuclear families)

Ömer's cows are all kept and grazed, fed and milked at YH fold, next to his father's house. Ömer lives in Polatlı, comes every day to take care of the herd (milk by machine)

To have them grazed by a shepherd..he said some give up to 30 kg. of milk daily, that's max. others 10-15 kg. Everyday, twice, Polatlı merchants come to pick up the milk.

The Danon yoghurt company established a plant in Polatlı, so they have a good market!

Ömer's cows are German race Holsteins...the calves are not allowed to nurse, they drink from a bucket..otherwise they'd never leave their mothers, I was told!

Ömer lives with his wife and 2 kids at his father's house permanently during summer, because he has to take care of the cows which are penned at his father's house. In Winter he makes trips between YH and Polatlı where he has a home. He says, "parasal" olay benim elimde (even though M. Ali is still considered the Head).

Transcription: This is Ömer's full-time preoccupation. (Once he was a salesman for a jeweler in Polatlı). At YH we started large-scale milk production last year. Kaymakamlık Sabancı/Danon firması ile anlaştı ve Polatlı civar köylerinden süt toplamaya başladı. KH, Beyliköprü also do production. This is good also for cutting off the small buyers "korsan" who bought milk for very low prices from us. Sabancı's wholesale price is a bit over half that of the retail in Ankara.

State Subsidy: given to milk prices (it is deposited to our bank account) and price of cows which have good, pedigree certificates. Type of business encouragement.

To what extent has milk production changed? A lot. In the past a few families sold it in Polatlı to individuals. Now the Firm reps. Come to pick it up 2x per day.

PRODUCTION: Each cow should produce 20 kg/day on average. Otherwise it is not cost-effective.

COST: Feed, veterinarian, cow-shed building, price of cow...that has risen.

Ömer does not have farmland, no sheep herd. This is his only income.

Investment Money was given by his father; so, the income and costs are shared by two families.

No of cows: I have 13 cows which yield milk. Altogether, 40, including steers, calves. I get 200 kg./day from 13. In summer they go grazing, so feed is minimal cost. I pay 25 million (since then the new unit is thousand) for feed/day. In winter, I have to feed.

But I plant clover and will make "silage" for winter.

(Silage: the whole green plant of corn is cut up and pulverized; mixed with barley, some hay and salt; put in a pile, and covered with plastic. It is hermetically closed. It is preserved like "turşu" for the winter). That is very good feed. Plus we give yem, and yonca. But to give only feed would be very expensive. This way we can keep 50% of the feed cost, and the cows would be healthier.

Do you work alone? YES... Milking takes one hour each, morning and evening, from 13 cows; it is done with machinery. I need help, surely, especially for preparing "slaj". I am intending to increase it to 150 when I find a place to build a more appropriate shed.

Zekeriya and I can't work together; he said he couldn't work with me on milk. He is "titiz"(picky). He works for the Kazi. Of course, he also has a share in this investment.

M. Ali breeds bees. Ömer bought bee hives for him, after his retirement.

So, they all work and cooperate together.

"Birlikten kuvvet doğar".

My parents did not own any land. My father was a shepherd first, then he became a museum guard..I did

not get land because I live in Polatlı.

Breeding: We are now breeding Holsteins here which are more adapted to the climate here. In Holland, Germany they are used to cold climates.

Space is the limiting factor, not grazing land, in milk production. Since this village is Sit Alanı, we cannot build here. And my father's courtyard is not big enough to expand. So, I cannot grow beyond 75 here.

Short-term Consequences of Milk Production: Will sheep get less? How will it affect agriculture?

Agriculture will be affected; people will have to plant corn in place of wheat or barley. Clover etc..Or, in my case, I will have to rent land to grow corn.

Pancar, soğan will be eliminated..Wheat and barley will still be sown, but it will diminish.

Information on Bee-Keeping: (did not transcribe all info.)

My fa-in-law 13 kovandan 9x30kg = 270 kg. bal aldı. Sold kg. for 7 mill TL

So, it is about 2 billion TL.

We get bee-keepers from Muğla also. Their season is over in the south.

26.6.02

Aşağı Ömerler –

With Fevzi Akyar- **Halil Oğlu Yatağı**; c.1 km north of Fincan T.

We are going to Akyar mevkii to see his herd with the Shepherd. 4 sheepdogs, 3 brothers and 1 sister. The males are pretty fierce, female "kancik" is mild.Latter is not chained as others are.

I am keeping these 2 month old lambs till Kurban Bayram, to get them fattened, so they'd sell for more, instead of selling them now. I don't milk my sheep, because I have no one to milk them.

Burasi Halil Oğlu yatağı, dedem burayı satın almış. So, it is like 200 years old, still functioning.

(It is on our pre '60s map, I marked it with his name). About 1 km west of it there is an old ağıl which has not functioned in 55 years, called Hüseyin Akyar ağıl.. this is where we kept the goats, and at the Halil Oğlu yatağı we kept the sheep. There are a number of caves near it.

Area has no water, dry and not much grazing. Fevzi put tubs of water , c. 2 km from ağıl so they can drink after the early morning grazing. Water comes from pipes, from Porsuk, energized by motor. (He plans to bring a 5 ton tanker closer to the ağıl in the future) Böylece Davar ezilmez.

Daily cycle: I have c. 400 sheep, including lambs, and 1 goat. He leads the herd.

Start at 4:00am, till about 11 am when they come back to the ağıl, then to the tubs of water. They drink, they rest till 5:00 pm.

The shepherd also eats his 2nd meal.

At 5:00 pm they start to go to “Kirmalar” (I photographed as Fevzi was talking for correspondence, Slide #2). Comes back around 10-11 pm.

At night they don't go into agil, they just sleep outdoors, over the kayalik, above the fold.

In Winter We keep the herd at the agil, they don't come to village at all.

Shepherd is from Mihalliçık. He stays with them for 12 months. I pay him salary, give him his food, shoes, clothing for the whole year, even his cigarettes. I bring his tea, eggplant, tomatoes etc...and he cooks it himself. Same in winter.

-

Feed in Winter: I have a pile of hay here; I cover it with plastic and put ash on top. Ash keeps the plastic intact, does not tear the plastic. Stays just like in the barn.

Hay is mixed with barley, commercial feed.

Birth: I let the ram in mid September; birth Starts in mid February, for a whole month. 300 ewes give birth then (döl dökmek). They nurse for 2-3 months. The summer births are called “Koç kaçkını”..-koç was naughty-.

I take care of the latter for another month at home, then let them graze to fatten up for sale.

My herd is largely Merinos. I converted Karaman gradually to Merinos by cross-breeding them.

Because the buyer would not pay for the weight of the big tail. Because people did not eat the fat anymore. The ram can attack people, they are jealous of the ewes.

Agriculture: My fields are 2 km from Porsuk, irrigated from Porsuk through pipes. We also irrigate wheat. First tractor came here in 1951.

At **Basri** village, there is c. 1,000 sheep and goats.

19.6.02

I spoke with Mustafa Çoban, Fazlı Çoban's son at his home. He did not want me to record the information (I don't know why).

So, the data is only by memory.

About Land Reform and Distribution – The first distribution was in 1952. (Also look up Ratip Esen's info/field notes '95) At that time each family got 190 d. If they already had land with a deed, the amount was deducted from 190, and the difference was given. They got the deed right away, the payment was nominal, over a period of 10-15 yrs. But if they did not till it within a year or two, the government would take it away, and give it to another HH. (A man with wife, with or without children is considered a HH whether he lives under the same roof with the head of the HH or another house in the village).

Mustafa said Hazine lands were different from Devlet lands. They are both State agencies, with separate accounting systems. Second distribution was in 1999 when 45 d. of land was given to each HH (married couple w/ or without children).

2.7.2002 Yassihöyük – Feridun Yavuz and his wife Bedia

More on LAND DISTRIBUTION and REFORM:

Feridun is one of the most economically alert, clever farmers. He reminds me of Fazlı Çoban. He calculates his profits and losses clearly, supervises his sons, makes decisions about management of their family business.

Feridun is Ömer Yavuz' son, Sefer's nephew. He is 62 yrs. Old.

First distribution was 1952. The State gave 190 d. to each household. His father had 350-400 d. He had deeds, he paid his real estate taxes, deeds were registered in his name. He did not get any land, because he already had more than 190 d. He died in 1971, at age 63. Ömer was adopted by two elderly women, worked for them, brought his brother Sefer and parents to YH from Kibriscık.

Next distribution was in 1999. Each married man had different amounts of land, from 45 to 75 d. on condition that he worked on it. Each person has to pay within 15 years, a certain designated amount, then he gets his deed.

This is unfair situation: a young unmarried man, to be married, does not get land. But how can he get married if he does not have any land? A ridiculous distribution. Now there is no more land to have in YH. Unless the owner does not pay within 15 yrs. State takes it back from him.

HOUSEHOLD – I have 4 boys, two girls. . (Daughters are living away with their husbands). We are 11 in this HH; 5 grandchildren, 2 sons and 2 gelsins, and two of us. My father had 7 children; long after his death, we divided it into individual families. My sons will live in a new house we bought in YH.

But in winter the sons and families live in Polatlı, grandchildren go to school in Polatlı. But the REAL Income comes from YH.

LABOR: Two sons and Soner Atiktig and other workers. Soner will be married soon, and he will live near Feridun, in Ünal's old house. Soner is almost like one of them, member of the household.

Feridun is the **HEAD** OF THE HOUSEHOLD, AND HE MAKES THE IMPORTANT ECONOMIC DECISIONS.

However, we work and make a living corporately, as an extended family, with 3 nuclear families.

PRODUCTION: They own 230 d. plus he rents out several 100 d.

How do you decide what, how much and where to plant? I divide the land into the number of crops I want to plant: sugar beet, wheat, barley, melon, onion.

We plant: **sugar beet**: 120d; **onion**: 60 d; **cereal**: 300 d.; **melon**: 40-50d.

(total: 530 d.

Sugar beet: once every 4 years in one field; alternate green crop with cereals. We don't have Nadas. The field is empty only for 3-4 months.

Since it is all irrigated, we continue every year.

There is quota on sugar beet, I can only grow 300 tons every year. That means 50 d. of land. Rest is dependent upon how much of each crop I can afford to plant. Green crops are expensive to grow, 7-8 times of water; 3x harrowing; 70 kg. of fertilizer/ d. It is yaprak gübre, if the yield is good, we may profit. We have 50 sheep. Soner takes "katıntı" and all other brothers' herds. Altogether 150 sheep.

Their house complexes consist of the oldest house where Ömer Aga and his wife lived. He had 2 wives altogether; 1st one died. There are 7 siblings from 2 wives. Feridun lives in an older 2-storey house with his family, and 2 brothers live across from him with their families, each in a newly restored house. Ömer's house is kept intact in the complex, no one lives there, because the mother died recently, and we went to her 40th mevlid.

Why did you part from your siblings economically? Main reason is that each family has different numbers of people...So, that may lead to inequities.

In YH we are 4 Household Heads....Then, there is Sefer, our uncle and his family.

Income: This year wheat is 230,000/kg. But that may change later.

Wheat is paid for right away, but sugar beet is paid after 7-8 months; that stalls our buying power because we can't make payments on our debts.

S. beet was 37,000 TL/kg. last year. I get c. 3-10 tons /d. depending on how it is tended. S. beet is also bought by the State. They say it might be privatized. But if the private factory is far, transportation cost is high. So, it is the same difference.

Investment is high; fertilizer, seed, oil, parts of machinery, electricity, shepherd fees, children's needs...

Our clear profit is very little; and if we did not work ourselves, that would not even be possible (we talked about taking a trip to Europe—he and his wife—it would cost about 16 billion TL. He said he would not even have that sum to re-invest for the following year. So, how could he spend that on a vacation? His wife nods, as well. He says, “ben elimin nasırı ile alnımın terini yiyorum”, meaning it is almost subsistence, even though there are a lot of crops and large plot of land. “Çalışırsan ancak yiyorsun”.

LABOR: Bedia – Before his brothers married and brought their brides, **we worked together in the fields..all male siblings and myself.**

We had 2,500 sheep, Shepherd took the sheep, we milked them;

We worked in the fields. We did all the work ourselves. The income is good, but “gider” daha çok. Now we pay the workers.

Diet: We grew all our Food, including vegetables. I put away for winter meat, bulgur..I used to make 30 yarım bulgur..(480 kg) by myself. “Çobanlar, bekarlar da bizimle yiyordu. We had 2 shepherds and two permanent workers. They ate a lot, and also other foods. That was 40 years ago. I made bulgur at the dibek near the Muhtarlık. (The other one, black basalt near the old mosque came from the Citadel). Later we took bulgur to the mills at SÖ and Çaglayık..until the water force became less, and the mill did not work. We used Ekstra wheat for both Bulgur and Bread. Ekstra was not yielding as much. So, we stopped it.

We used to eat a lot more meat...we butchered sheep and cow frequently.

We put away “kavurma” for winter. We cooked it well, “tam kıvamı ile yaparsan evde bir yıl durur, hiç birsey olmaz. Buzdolabı istemez.

In the past we had basement storage; almost deep freeze- 1 to 1.5 m. below ground..there we kept cheese, meat pickled veg. Etc... We had it at our house. Father's house first floor was for storage, second floor was living quarters. We used to eat a lot more kaymak, butter, bulgur etc...kuyruk yağı was used. We were healthier. Remzi's father was like that, he lived to be 94. Now we live less, with lots of diseases. In the past, we worked harder, lived longer. Two men Ate 1 tray of baklava.

Yoghurt made from sheep milk.

MILK PRODUCTION: Is it a profitable pursuit? The young don't believe me, but it is not a long-term profit. Because the sale price is half of what it sells for in the market..but the feed price goes up.

It can be profitable under 2 conditions: 1) as a “yan” gelir, 2) as a cooperative that produces the cheese, yoghurt etc...ourselves.

It is like breeding Merinos, instead of Karaman. When we were given good price for Merinos wool, we all switched to that. But now market is glutted with Merinos. So....what will happen when market is glutted with milk?

About goat breeding: Not economical; milk production is for 2 months, 20 kg/goat. People don't buy the meat. Wool has no market. Because the textile industry moved to more synthetic textiles.

(His father died when Feridun was 30; he also supervised his sons until he died. He had come from Kibriscık and adopted by two elderly wives of an Aga who did not have children. So Omer brought his mother and father and brother Sefer from Kibriscık to live in YH. His mother was already from the nearby village Basrı. This was the beginning of their long-term settlement at YH). (Sefer's wife Sultan is also from Basrı).

Feridun's wife Bedia is from SÖ; she married at 15, lived here for 45 yrs.

(Spectacular abandoned and decaying house of M. Ali Kahraman- was built with indoor plumbing, beautiful woodwork, tiled bathroom...he died in 1958..left to decay after.

He was a very prosperous farmer, one of the 3-4 families at YH.

The village was already here during Sakarya War. Before that they were at KK, it was a large village there).

5.7.2002